PEW RESEARCH CENTER
MAY 26-29, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,000

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	DK/ Refused
a. Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit					
May 26-29, 2011	25	26	20	29	*
May 12-15, 2011	21	26	24	28	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
May 5-8, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt*	29	28	22	20	1
April 21-25, 2011	30	31	18	21	*
April 14-17, 2011	36	27	18	19	1
April 7-10, 2011: *The threat of a government shutdown because of budget disagreements in Washington*	47	26	15	12	*
March 31-April 3, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit*	30	27	21	22	*
March 17-20, 2011	24	25	24	26	1
March 3-6, 2011	26	29	19	26	1
February 17-20, 2011	27	30	17	25	1
December 2-5, 2010	35	25	21	17	2
November 11-14, 2010: *Proposals made by leaders of the federal budget deficit commission*	15	21	21	41	1
January 9-12, 2009: *Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year*	35	30	19	16	*
November, 1990: *Congressional and administration efforts to reach a budget deficit agreement*	34	33	20	11	2
October, 1990: *Attempts by Congress and the administration to find ways to reduce the budget deficit*	34	37	17	12	*
b. News about state and local budget problems					
May 26-29, 2011	26	29	19	26	*
March 17-20, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
February 17-20, 2011	28	31	17	23	1
January 6-9, 2011	24	37	18	20	1
June 24-27, 2010	26	35	22	15	1
March 5-8, 2010	31	32	19	18	*
April 9-13, 2009	28	30	21	21	*
c. Deadly tornadoes in the Midwest					
May 26-29, 2011	45	33	13	9	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
May 5-8, 2011: *Tornadoes and flooding in the South and Midwest*	41	37	15	7	*
April 28-May 1, 2011: *Deadly storms in the South*	45	29	14	12	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April 21-25, 2011: *Deadly storms in the South and Midwest*	29	33	18	20	*
June 13-16, 2008: *A tornado that killed four Boy Scouts at a camp in Iowa*	32	35	17	16	*
May 30-June 2, 2008: *Midwest*[1]	30	33	21	15	1
February 8-11, 2008: *South and Midwest*	25	42	19	13	1
May 11-14, 2007: *Tornadoes and floods in the Midwest*	22	35	23	19	1
March 2-5, 2007: *South and Midwest*	33	38	18	11	*
May, 1999: *Oklahoma and Kansas*	38	40	15	6	1
d. President Barack Obama's trip to Europe					
May 26-29, 2011	11	21	27	40	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
November 11-14, 2010: *President Obama's trip to Asia*	18	26	21	33	2
November 4-7, 2010	14	21	23	40	1
November 20-23, 2009	11	19	29	41	*
November 13-16, 2009	8	19	28	44	1
August 14-17, 2009: *President Obama's trip to Mexico*	9	20	26	44	*
July 10-13, 2009: *President Obama's trip to Russia and the G-8 Summit in Italy*	14	30	24	30	1
April 17-20, 2009: *Trip to Mexico and Latin America*	17	26	25	32	*
April 9-13, 2009: *Visit to Turkey and Iraq*	23	29	22	26	*
April 3-6, 2009: *Trip to Europe and meetings with foreign leaders*	25	35	21	19	*
e. News about possible candidates for the 2012 presidential elections					
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
October 24-27, 2008: *2008 Presidential Election*	44	36	11	8	1
October 17-20, 2008	61	28	7	4	*
October 10-13, 2008	52	31	12	5	*
October 3-6, 2008	57	31	8	4	*
September 26-29, 2008	56	29	10	5	*
September 19-22, 2008	47	33	14	6	*
September 12-15, 2008	40	38	14	7	1
September 5-8, 2008	45	39	12	4	*
August 29-31, 2008	45	32	15	8	*
August 22-25, 2008	31	36	22	11	*
August 15-18, 2008	25	41	19	14	1
August 8-11, 2008	27	38	22	13	*
August 1-4, 2008	30	42	19	9	*

[1] March 2-5, 2007 through May 30-June 2, 2008 asked about "Violent storms and tornadoes" in each region. May, 1999 asked about "Tornadoes in Oklahoma and Kansas."

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 25-28, 2008	30	34	21	15	*
July 18-21, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
July 11-14, 2008	28	34	22	15	1
July 3-7, 2008	25	35	23	17	*
June 27-30, 2008	39	33	18	10	*
June 20-23, 2008	28	38	22	12	*
June 13-16, 2008	35	35	20	10	*
June 6-9, 2008	38	35	17	10	*
May 30-June 2, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
May 22-25, 2008	32	37	20	11	*
May 16-19, 2008	33	37	19	10	1
May 9-12, 2008	35	36	18	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	27	35	23	14	1
April 25-28, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
April 18-21, 2008	29	41	19	10	1
April 11-14, 2008	31	37	22	10	*
April 4-7, 2008	33	36	17	14	*
March 28-31, 2008	31	41	18	10	*
March 20-24, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
March 14-17, 2008	40	37	16	7	*
March 7-10, 2008	39	36	15	9	1
February 29-March 3, 2008	43	34	14	9	*
February 22-25, 2008	42	37	13	8	*
February 15-18, 2008	44	36	10	10	*
February 8-11, 2008	39	37	15	9	0
February 1-4, 2008	37	35	16	12	*
January 25-28, 2008	36	37	14	12	1
January 18-21, 2008	36	34	18	12	*
January 11-14, 2008[2]	32	31	19	17	1
January 4-7, 2008	33	36	19	11	1
December 14-17, 2007	25	34	22	19	*
December 7-10, 2007	24	35	22	19	*
November 30 – December 3, 2007	23	35	23	19	*
November 23-26, 2007	20	33	26	20	1
November 16-19, 2007	26	33	21	19	1
November 9-12, 2007	21	33	25	21	*
November 2-5, 2007	27	30	21	21	1
October 26-29, 2007	21	34	26	19	*
October 19-22, 2007	23	32	22	23	*
October 12-15, 2007	13	31	26	30	*
October 5-8, 2007	22	30	24	24	*
September 28 – October 1, 2007	21	34	25	20	*
September 21-24, 2007	24	31	22	23	*
September 14-17, 2007	22	31	24	23	*
September 7-10, 2007	18	34	26	22	*
August 30-September 2, 2007	19	35	21	25	*
August 24-27, 2007	22	28	24	26	*
August 17-20, 2007	19	27	24	30	*
August 10-13, 2007	23	32	21	24	*
August 3-6, 2007	19	31	25	25	*
July 27-30, 2007	19	32	22	26	1
July 20-23, 2007	16	26	30	27	1
July 13-16, 2007	17	29	27	27	*
July 6-9, 2007	24	29	24	22	1
June 29-July 2, 2007	20	32	25	23	*
June 22-25, 2007	18	31	21	30	*
June 15-18, 2007	17	32	26	25	*

[2] January 11-14, 2008 asked about: "News about the New Hampshire primaries and the presidential campaign."

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
June 8-11, 2007	19	30	24	26	1
June 1-4, 2007	16	27	32	24	1
May 24-27, 2007	22	33	23	22	*
May 18-21, 2007	18	31	24	27	*
May 11-14, 2007	18	30	23	28	1
May 4-7, 2007	23	34	21	21	1
April 27-30, 2007	14	30	29	26	1
April 20-23, 2007	18	28	27	27	*
April 12-16, 2007	18	28	27	27	*
April 5-9, 2007	25	30	26	19	*
March 30-April 2, 2007	20	29	27	23	1
March 23-26, 2007	20	32	22	26	*
March 16-19, 2007	15	28	29	27	1
March 9-12, 2007	24	30	23	23	*
March 2-5, 2007	19	31	26	23	1
February 23-26, 2007	22	33	24	21	*
February 16-19, 2007	18	32	22	27	1
February 9-12, 2007	24	30	24	21	1
February 2-5, 2007	24	36	22	18	*
January 26-29, 2007	24	33	23	20	*
January 19-22, 2007[3]	24	27	22	26	1
November, 2004 (RVs): *2004 Presidential Election*	52	36	8	4	*
Mid-October, 2004	46	30	12	11	1
August, 2004	32	38	16	14	*
July, 2004	29	37	18	15	1
April, 2004	31	33	19	16	1
Mid-March, 2004	35	34	18	13	*
Late February, 2004	24	40	23	12	1
Early February, 2004[4]	29	37	20	13	1
Mid-January, 2004	16	30	27	26	1
Early January, 2004	14	32	30	23	1
December, 2003	16	26	27	30	1
November, 2003	11	26	34	28	1
October, 2003	12	27	28	32	1
September, 2003	17	25	30	27	1
Mid-August, 2003	12	27	27	33	1
May, 2003	8	19	31	41	1
January, 2003	14	28	29	28	1
Early November, 2000 *(RVs)*: *2000 Presidential Election*	39	44	12	5	*
Mid-October, 2000 *(RVs)*	40	37	15	8	*
Early October, 2000 *(RVs)*	42	36	15	6	1
September, 2000	22	42	21	15	*
July, 2000	21	38	20	20	1
June, 2000	23	32	23	21	1
May, 2000	18	33	26	23	*
April, 2000	18	39	22	20	1
March, 2000	26	41	19	13	1
February, 2000	26	36	21	17	*

[3] January 19-22, 2007 asked about: "Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2008."

[4] From May 2003 to Early February 2004 and in March 1992, the story was listed as "The race for the Democratic nomination." In January 2003, the story was listed as "Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2004." In September 2000, Early September and July 1996, and May 1992, the question asked about "the presidential election campaign." In January, March and April 1996, the story was listed as "News about the Republican presidential candidates." In August 1992, the story was listed as "News about the presidential election." In July 1992, the story was listed as "News about the presidential campaign." In January 1992, the story was listed as "News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination." In 1988, the story was introduced as being from "this past year" and was listed as "News about the presidential campaign in 1988."

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
January, 2000	19	34	28	18	1
December, 1999	16	36	24	23	1
October, 1999	17	32	28	22	1
September, 1999	15	31	33	20	1
July, 1999	15	38	24	22	1
June, 1999	11	25	29	34	1
November, 1996 *(RVs)*: *1996 Presidential Election*	34	45	15	6	*
October, 1996	31	39	18	12	*
f. Debate about how to resolve the Israeli-Palestinian dispute					
May 26-29, 2011	18	23	24	34	*
TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
September 30-October 3, 2010: *Israeli-Palestinian peace talks*	11	26	29	24	1
September 16-19, 2010	13	21	26	40	*
September 2-6, 2010: *Israeli-Palestinian peace talks in Washington*	14	24	27	35	1
March 26-29, 2010: *Reports about tensions between Israel and the United States*	20	27	21	31	1
March 19-22, 2010: *Reports about tensions in the Middle East between Israelis and Palestinians*	15	28	27	30	1
June 19-22, 2009: *The situation between Israelis and Palestinians*	15	26	30	29	1
January 23-26, 2009: *Conflict between the Israeli military and Hamas forces in Gaza*	31	31	18	20	*
January 16-19, 2009	24	31	22	22	1
January 9-12, 2009	34	35	18	13	0
January 2-4, 2009	28	32	22	18	*
March 7-10, 2008: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	20	33	26	21	*
January 11-14, 2008: *News about President Bush attending peace talks in Israel*	16	30	23	30	1
Nov. 30-Dec. 3, 2007: *The Middle East Peace Summit in Annapolis, Maryland*	11	25	24	39	1
August, 2006: *The military conflict between Israel and Hezbollah forces in Lebanon*	40	34	14	10	2
September, 2003: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	31	36	20	13	*
June, 2003: *President Bush's summit meeting with world leaders and with the prime ministers of Israel and the Palestinian Authority*	20	36	24	19	1
Early June, 2003: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	26	40	20	13	1
December, 2002	29	36	22	12	1
Early October, 2002	32	39	20	8	1
June, 2002	38	33	18	10	1
April, 2002	38	37	14	10	1
Early April, 2002	44	33	13	9	1
December, 2001	31	40	19	9	1
Early September, 2001	21	33	25	20	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April, 2001: *Continued violence in the Middle East*	22	34	24	19	1
January, 2001: *Renewed efforts at reaching a peace agreement in the Middle East*	21	32	29	17	1
Mid-October, 2000: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	30	38	18	13	1
Early October, 2000: *Renewed violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	21	30	27	21	1
July, 2000: *The Middle East peace summit at Camp David*	15	30	24	31	*
November, 1998: *The latest Mideast peace agreement between Israel and the Palestinians*	18	33	28	19	2
Early October, 1998 (RVs): *Renewed efforts at reaching a peace agreement in the Middle East*	21	40	27	12	*
January, 1997: *Renewed tensions between Israelis and Palestinians over Hebron*	12	23	29	35	1
October, 1996: *Renewed violence between Israelis & Palestinians on the West Bank and in Jerusalem*	17	34	26	23	*
September, 1995: *The latest Mideast peace agreement between Israel and the Palestinians*	11	32	29	27	1
Late September, 1993: *The peace accords between Israel and the PLO*	23	33	24	19	1
Early September, 1993: *Talks between Israel and the PLO about Arab self-rule for the Gaza Strip and the West Bank town of Jericho*	19	31	23	26	1
January, 1993: *Israel's expulsion of 400 Moslem fundamentalists following the murder of an Israeli soldier in the West Bank*	10	25	31	33	1
October, 1991: *President Bush's decision to postpone loan guarantees to Israel*	15	25	30	29	1
June, 1990: *The incident in Gaza in which a deranged Israeli killed seven Palestinians and the West Bank riots that followed*	11	28	30	30	1
May, 1988: *The conflict in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis in the occupied territories*	18	37	34	9	2

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

May 26-29 2011	
48	Deadly tornadoes in the Midwest
8	Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit
7	News about state and local budget problems
5	News about possible candidates for the 2012 presidential elections
5	Debate about how to resolve the Israeli-Palestinian dispute
3	President Barack Obama's trip to Europe
10	Some other story **(VOL.)**
13	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 How much if anything, have you heard about each of the following? Have you heard a lot, a little or nothing at all? **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE WITH ITEM d ALWAYS LAST]**

	A lot	A little	Nothing at all	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. The end of Oprah Winfrey's daytime talk show				
May 26-29, 2011	36	37	26	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:				
May 19-22, 2011: *Katie Couric stepping down from her role as anchor of the CBS Evening News*	8	47	44	1
July 1-5, 2010: *Larry King announcing he will retire from his CNN talk show in the fall*	15	45	39	1
November 20-23, 2009: *Oprah Winfrey announcing that she will end her daytime talk show in 2011*	33	45	21	1
November 9-12, 2007: *Possible abuse of students at Oprah Winfrey's school for disadvantaged girls in South Africa*	23	50	27	*
September 14-17, 2007: *Oprah Winfrey's decision to support Barack Obama for president*	16	46	38	*
b. Allegations that Lance Armstrong used performance-enhancing drugs during his cycling career				
May 26-29, 2011	19	44	37	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:				
January 15-18, 2010: *Retired baseball player Mark McGwire admitting he used steroids during his career*	30	55	15	*
c. A judge ruling that Jared Loughner is not mentally competent to stand trial for the Arizona shooting rampage that injured Congresswoman Gabrielle Giffords				
May 26-29, 2011	23	43	33	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:				
January 13-16, 2011: *Barack Obama's speech at the memorial for victims of the Arizona shooting*	37	38	25	1
January 13-16, 2011: *Sarah Palin's comments on the Arizona shooting*	19	39	40	1

Now a different kind of question …

PEWWP.1 Thinking about the candidates running for the Republican presidential nomination, if you had to use one single word to describe your overall impression of this group of candidates, what would that one word be? **[IF "DON'T KNOW" PROBE ONCE:** Even if you haven't thought much about this yet, just your first impression or the first word that comes to mind…**] [OPEN END: RECORD FIRST MENTION ONLY]**

NOTE: The numbers listed represent the number of respondents who offered each response; the numbers are not percentages.

May 26-29 2011	
42	Not impressed/unimpressed
21	Disappointed/Disappointing
21	Weak
18	Good
17	Incompetent/Incapable
16	Pathetic
14	Not interested
14	Unqualified/Not qualified
13	Idiots
12	Poor
11	Confused/Confusing/Confusion
10	Hopeful
10	Interesting
10	Mediocre
9	Not good
8	Fair
8	Liars
8	Pitiful
8	Ridiculous
8	Unknown
7	Boring
7	Conservative
7	Disgusting
7	Joke
7	Lacking/Lackluster
7	Losers

May 26-29 2011	
7	Qualified/Highly qualified
6	Competent
6	Diverse
6	Impressed/Impressive
6	Sad
5	Inadequate
5	Lousy
5	Stupid
5	Untrustworthy
4	Bad
4	Blah/Bland
4	Capable
4	Crazy
4	Dishonest
4	Dislike/Don't like/Unlikeable
4	Disorganized/Unorganized
4	Greedy
4	Honesty
4	Republican
4	Terrible
4	Undecided
4	Unelectable
4	Waiting/Wait and see
328	Other
15	Don't know
230	No answer/Refused

Now a few questions about America's place in the world…
ASK ALL:
PEW.4 Please tell me whether you agree or disagree with each of the following statements. **[RANDOMIZE LIST]**

	Agree	Disagree	(VOL.) DK/Ref
a. The United States should cooperate fully with the United Nations			
May 26-29, 2011	58	36	6
November 12-15, 2009	51	38	11
December, 2006	57	35	8
October, 2005	54	39	7
August, 2004	60	30	10
December, 2002	67	28	5
Early September, 2001	58	31	11
March, 1999	65	26	9
September, 1997	59	30	11
June, 1995	62	30	8
February, 1995	65	29	6
October, 1993	64	28	8
April, 1993	71	22	7
Gallup: 1991[5]	77	17	6
Gallup: 1985	56	35	9
Gallup: 1980	59	28	13
Gallup: 1976	46	41	13
Gallup: 1972	63	28	9
Gallup: 1968	72	21	7
Gallup: 1964	72	16	12
b. In deciding on its foreign policies, the U.S. should take into account the views of its major allies			
May 26-29, 2011	79	16	5
Nov 12-15, 2009	78	14	8
December, 2006	82	12	6
October, 2005	79	16	5
August, 2004	76	14	10
December, 2002	85	10	5
Early September, 2001	80	11	9
March, 1999	82	12	6
September, 1997	72	18	10
June, 1995	74	18	8
April, 1993	80	13	7
Gallup: 1991	86	10	4
Gallup: 1985	82	12	6
Gallup: 1980	79	13	8
Gallup: 1976	72	18	10
Gallup: 1972	80	12	8
Gallup: 1968	84	9	7
Gallup: 1964	81	7	12
c. Since the U.S. is the most powerful nation in the world, we should go our own way in international matters, not worrying too much about whether other countries agree with us or not			
May 26-29, 2011	35	62	3
November 12-15, 2009	44	51	5
December, 2006	28	68	4
October, 2005	32	63	5
August, 2004	28	65	7
December, 2002	25	72	3

[5] Trends for this series in 1991 and earlier are from public opinion surveys conducted by Potomac Associates, The Gallup Organization and the Institute for International Social Research.

PEW.4 CONTINUED…

	Agree	Disagree	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Early September, 2001	32	62	6
March, 1999	26	69	5
September, 1997	32	62	6
June, 1995	34	60	6
April, 1993	34	63	3
Gallup: 1991	29	66	5
Gallup: 1985	26	70	4
Gallup: 1980	26	66	8
Gallup: 1976	29	62	9
Gallup: 1972	22	72	6
Gallup: 1968	23	72	5
Gallup: 1964	19	70	11
d. The U.S. should mind its own business internationally and let other countries get along the best they can on their own			
May 26-29, 2011	46	50	4
November 12-15, 2009	49	44	7
December, 2006	42	53	5
October, 2005	42	51	7
August, 2004	34	59	7
December, 2002	30	65	5
Early September, 2001	37	55	8
March, 1999	35	57	8
September, 1997	39	54	7
June, 1995	41	51	8
April, 1993	37	58	5
Gallup: 1991	33	60	7
Gallup: 19852	34	59	7
Gallup: 1980	30	61	9
Gallup: 1976	41	49	10
Gallup: 1972	35	56	9
Gallup: 1968	27	66	7
Gallup: 1964	18	70	12
e. We should not think so much in international terms but concentrate more on our own national problems and building up our strength and prosperity here at home			
May 26-29, 2011	76	21	3
November 12-15, 2009	76	19	4
December, 2006	69	26	5
October, 2005	71	23	6
August, 2004	69	25	6
December, 2002	65	31	4
Early September, 2001	68	25	7
March, 1999	68	27	5
September, 1997	72	24	4
June, 1995	78	18	4
April, 1993	79	18	3
Gallup: 1991	78	16	6
Gallup: 1985	60	34	6
Gallup: 1980	61	30	9
Gallup: 1976	73	22	5
Gallup: 1972	73	20	7
Gallup: 1968	60	31	9
Gallup: 1964	55	32	13